

Digital habits

The digital world enables teens to stay connected with friends beyond face-to-face contact. It is an extension of their real-world contact, allowing teens to be sociable and engage in activities with their friends even when they're away from them.

Digital respect

A person's virtual self is an extension of their real self. Just as many teens decorate their bedrooms to reflect their interests and personalities, so, too, do they embellish their social media profiles. Therefore, just as a person's behavior in the real world is a reflection of their values, such as showing respect to others and expecting respect in return, so it is in the digital world. The same rules apply: think before speaking, and think before posting.

▷ Think before posting

Just because posting online is easy to do, doesn't mean it doesn't need great care and thought.



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◀ 130–131 Social media

◀ 134–135 Making judgments

Staying safe online

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PARENT TIPS

Model good behavior

- Teens can pick up habits from those around them, so model good behavior, such as putting down your phone when talking to people or at the dinner table.
- Engage with your teen about their digital profile just as you do with their day-to-day life, but respect their desire for autonomy.
- Discuss appropriate and inappropriate content with your teen.
- Turn off your phone before bedtime.

Netiquette

Good etiquette shows good manners and respect, and good Internet etiquette—or netiquette—shows the same. It is important to consider and follow this code of conduct to make the digital world safe and unthreatening. Unfortunately, some people abuse the Internet, behave badly, or target the online community for personal gain.



△ Spam

Unsolicited ads or messages—spam—are a nuisance and are sometimes used for phishing or spreading malware.



△ Illegal downloads

File sharing and streaming enables users to access copyrighted material without the copyright owner's consent. This is illegal.



△ Abusive language

The faceless anonymity that the Internet gives allows some users to act abusively and aggressively in ways they wouldn't face-to-face. Some forms of abusive language are illegal.